contributed. Nearly all the collection came in anna and paisa rather than in rupees indicating the economic position of contributors.[125]

Bharati continued with his desperate appeals, calling for unity and concerted effort in the face of what seemed to be public apathy. He drew religious parallels: of the concerted efforts to churn the milky ocean to get *amritam*; of the temple festival where hundreds gather to pull the temple car through the streets.[126] But to little avail.

All that was left to do was to understand, explain and theorize. Drawing on Thirukkural, Bharati titled one of his essays, 'Make Wealth!' To aspire to freedom, material resources are required. But, in a land stripped of its freedom, it was well-nigh impossible to produce material wealth. A people without freedom lacked initiative, resourcefulness and vigour. How to break this vicious cycle, despaired Bharati. But if one got bogged down in philosophical speculations, it would only result in national ruin. Bharati therefore took recourse to pragmatism. To learn swimming, one must first take the plunge. An overwhelming majority of the people should join hands, employ modern technology, travel afar and acquire industrial knowledge. A small minority should shun wealth, educate the people about the importance of liberty and expound on its philosophical foundations. Philosophical knowledge was the lodestar for the ship of liberty while material wealth was the rudder that helped the ship to keep clear of the rocks. About the appeal for Rs 2 lakh and the eventual collection of a mere two hundred, what could a poor nation do? Wealth was like food: it benefits those who labour, by nurturing their bodies and infusing new blood; the very same wealth, on the other hand, proves to be a toxin to idle people. Pointing to the proverbial ghost that guarded a treasure—of no use to anybody—Bharati added, there were too few of them in our country. Finally, he urged Indians to make modest efforts rather than dream big. If you did not have big capital, start with a simple loom. The fantastic dreams of a misty-eyed poet lay in ruins.[127]

Swallowing his Tamil pride, Bharati, in one cartoon, depicted the success of Swadeshi industry in Bengal while it floundered in the south due to the